

Return of the Native

The re-emergence of a 1985 plan to repatriate non-local employees and create extra posts for them in their respective regions threatens to destabilise the entire administrative machinery of the state

■ By Amarnath K. Menon

It may seem absurd but it is true. If you are a government employee anywhere in Andhra Pradesh and you don't belong to that region, it is mandatory for you to vacate your present post in favour of a person from that area. This probably makes nonsense of the constitutionally enshrined rights to work and to move around freely, but Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy could do little but try to keep a straight face, while setting June 30 as the deadline to comply with the promises made by his predecessor, N.T. Rama Rao and N. Chandrababu Naidu. The order is a bizarre "return of the native" scheme that has become an uphill task for Reddy to accomplish by the end of this month.

By repatriating all non-local employees and creating supernumer-

ary posts for them in their respective regions, the state wants to portray that it has not forgotten the government order (G.O.) 610 of 1985. The majority of the repatriates are from the police, education, medical and health services departments. While all non-locals who joined after 1985 will be repatriated first, for the police personnel the process is to be completed in phases. This phased process would extend until December 2008, as sending a large number of police officers is fraught with the problem of finding local replacements immediately.

No less than 10,000 employees in 103 departments are likely to be affected by the G.O. 610. The officials point out that the mere issuance of these orders will not solve the contentious issue. To set the anomaly right, supernumer-

BAFFLED: Reddy faces bureaucratic hurdles

ary posts have to be created and a special recruitment drive has to be taken up to fill the vacancies. "The functioning of several government departments is likely to be disrupted by the sudden unplanned changes in the hierarchy," says a senior civil servant. "The identification process is almost complete and the rest will be done well in time for the June end deadline. There is no going back," claims higher education minister, D. Srinivas, who heads a six-member cabinet sub

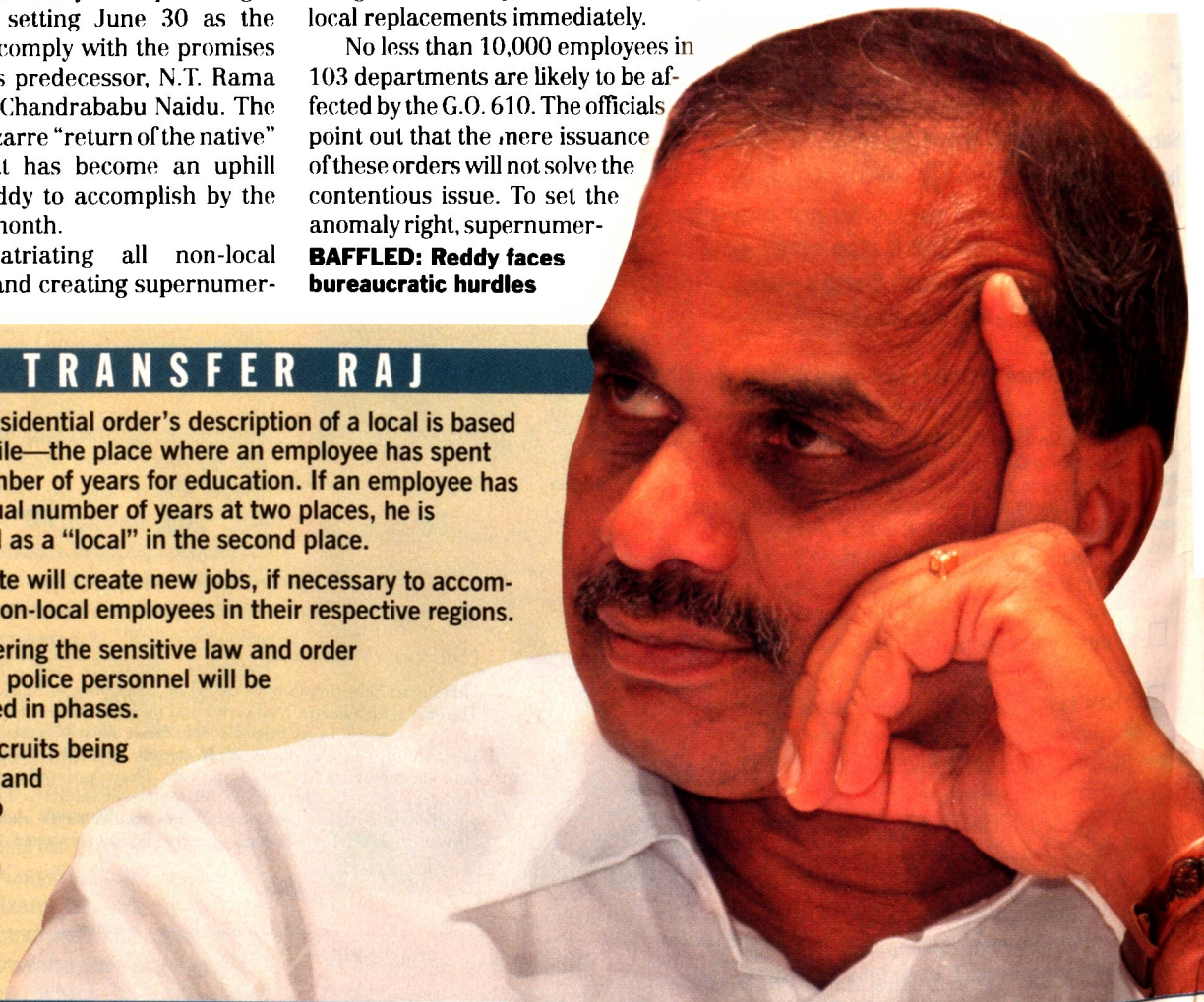
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■ The presidential order's description of a local is based on domicile—the place where an employee has spent more number of years for education. If an employee has spent equal number of years at two places, he is described as a "local" in the second place.

■ The state will create new jobs, if necessary to accommodate non-local employees in their respective regions.

■ Considering the sensitive law and order situation, police personnel will be repatriated in phases.

■ New recruits being inducted and trained to take over jobs from those transferred.



RS 10 cr is what the state will spend on travel assistance